

Your best-ranking asset for your own head term is a stranger's Reddit comment.

A live Google result for *healthcare payroll software*, pulled 14 September 2026 at 16:44 UTC, United States. This is the page a payroll director sees before a rep ever gets the call.

#4

REDDIT, RECOMMENDING EMPEON

"Look at Empeon. That's all they do." Not on empeon.com.

0

EMPEON.COM IN THE TOP 9

Paylocity, Netchex and ADP hold the first three.

3 : 0

AI OVERVIEW CITATIONS, NETCHEX : EMPEON

Google's AI answer names five vendors. Empeon is not one.

LIVE ORGANIC RESULT, 14 SEP 2026

#	DOMAIN	WHAT RANKS
1	paylocity.com	Healthcare industry page
2	netchex.com	Healthcare payroll page
3	adp.com	Healthcare payroll article
4	reddit.com	r/Payroll thread recommending Empeon
5	celeryway.com	"Top 6" listicle, 23 Aug 2026
6	onpay.com	Doctors and healthcare page
7	axiomhrs.com	Healthcare HCM page
8	apspayroll.com	Healthcare industry page
9	medesk.net	"6 Best" listicle, 31 May 2026
—	empeon.com	Absent from page one

Source: live SERP observation, United States, English. No paid results and no local pack on this query. Features present: AI Overview, People Also Ask, related searches.

WHAT GOOGLE'S AI OVERVIEW TELLS THE SAME BUYER

VENDOR NAMED	POSITIONED AS
ADP Workforce Now	Large, multi-state systems
UKG Ready / Pro	24/7 shift complexity
Netchex	"Best overall" for credential tracking
Gusto	Small single-site clinics
Paycor	Earned wage access

Cited sources in the answer: netchex.com (3), celeryway.com (2), youtube.com (2), gusto.com, adp.com, apspayroll.com, outsourceaccelerator.com (1 each). empeon.com: 0. The answer's own feature list names PBJ.

NETCHEX IS NOT ONE LIST. IT IS A FRANCHISE.

Netchex publishes 2026 "5 best payroll software" lists for skilled nursing, healthcare, assisted living, hospitals and health systems, and hospice. Each ranks Netchex first. A buyer researching any Empeon vertical meets a shortlist Empeon did not write and is not on.

The specialist is moving. Viventium added scheduling and time & attendance on 2 September 2026, after acquiring Apploi, "available immediately for skilled nursing and senior living." That is the cluster the audit parked in wave two. It is now a displacement conversation for your reps, not a content plan.

Read this the right way. Demand for exactly what Empeon sells exists and is answered every day by three larger vendors, two listicles, and one anonymous Reddit user. The homepage already says PBJ and HPPD. The product truth is not the problem. Nobody finds it at the moment they are looking.

WHAT EMPEON.COM ALREADY SAYS, THAT THE SEARCH RESULT NEVER SHOWS

20M+

PAYCHECKS A YEAR

With 97.5% client retention and 50-state tax support, all on the homepage.

8

OPERATOR LOGOS

AnchorHealth, CentersChoice, Edison, Help at Home, FreedomCare, Hill Valley, United, Excelsior.

5

COMPETING CTAS

Get Started, See How it Works, View Our Solutions, Our Industry Expertise, Contact Us. One should win.

Homepage observed 14 Sep 2026. H1: "The workforce platform healthcare operations run on." Primary CTA "Get Started" → /book-demo/. PBJ reporting and HPPD calculation are named on the homepage; the combined healthcare, PBJ, HPPD and wage-parity sentence sits in the payroll FAQ.

Google already trusts Empeon on PBJ and HPPD. The commercial versions are unclaimed.

Volumes: Google Keyword Planner, US, 14 Sep 2026. Positions: DataForSEO US index, empeon.com top 200 and each competitor's top 150. Neither Netchex nor Viventium ranks in its top 150 for a single PBJ or HPPD term. Empeon holds nine in the top ten.

WAVE ONE • COMMERCIAL WEDGE: OWN THE PAGE, NOT THE COMMENT

KEYWORD	US / MO	COMP.	EMPEON TODAY	WHO HOLDS IT	WHY IT WINS
healthcare payroll software	110	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Paylocity 1, Netchex 2, ADP 3 (live, 14 Sep)	A Reddit comment already says Empeon at 4. A real page beats a comment.
payroll software for healthcare	110	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Netchex 2 (index)	Same page as the head term, second phrasing.
best payroll software for healthcare	70	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Netchex 4 (index)	Every list omits Empeon. Write the list.
snf payroll	90	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Neither competitor in its top 150	The exact operator vocabulary. Unclaimed.
home care payroll software	30	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Viventium 1 for "home care payroll"	Repoint the existing home-health solution page.
pbj reporting software	10	Low	Not in indexed top 200	None observed	Ten searches a month, all of them buyers.

WAVE ONE • PBJ AND HPPD: EXTEND THE AUTHORITY GOOGLE ALREADY GRANTS

KEYWORD	US / MO	COMP.	EMPEON TODAY	WHO HOLDS IT	WHY IT WINS
pbj reporting	320	Low	3 for "what is pbj reporting"	Neither competitor in its top 150	Largest PBJ term. Empeon already answers the definitional version.
cms pbj	170	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Neither competitor	CMS-vocabulary query; iQIES deadline content lands here.
payroll based journal	140	Low	6	Neither competitor	One page from the top three.
hppd calculator	70	Low	1 for "how to calculate hppd", 2 for "hours per patient day"	Neither competitor	Build the calculator Google already expects from Empeon.
payroll based journal reporting	50	Low	10	Neither competitor	Consolidate with the PBJ product page.
pbj reporting for nursing homes	40	Low	6	Neither competitor	Same page; add the FQ4 iQIES steps.

WAVE TWO, PULLED FORWARD • SCHEDULING AND SHIFT PAY: VIVENTIUM'S NEW FRONT

KEYWORD	US / MO	COMP.	EMPEON TODAY	WHO HOLDS IT	WHY IT WINS
home care scheduling software	480	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Viventium launched scheduling 2 Sep	Empeon sells Caregiver Scheduling. Largest term on this page.
caregiver scheduling software	170	Low	12 for "caregiver scheduling"	Neither competitor in its top 150	Already on page two. Product page, not blog.
home health scheduling software	140	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Neither competitor	Same page, second phrasing.
nursing home scheduling software	110	Medium	Not in indexed top 200	Neither competitor	SNF variant of the same page.
calculate shift differential	720	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Neither competitor	Calculator page; product does this automatically.
shift differential pay	590	Low	Not in indexed top 200	Neither competitor	Explainer with wage-parity and night/weekend rules.

What the competitors' organic strength actually is.

Netchex's indexed top 150 is its brand plus restaurant and hospitality payroll (restaurant payroll software, 4,400/mo, position 2). Viventium's is its brand plus bonus-tax calculators (22,200/mo, position 3) and "home care payroll" at 1. Their healthcare authority is a listicle franchise, not product pages.

Two honest notes. The audit quoted Semrush volume of 320 for the head term; Keyword Planner shows 110. Both are estimates; the intent is the same. "iQIES PBJ" has no volume yet because the system launched 17 August. That is the window.

"Not in indexed top 200" means the term is absent from empeon.com's 200 highest-ranked indexed keywords, not a claim of zero visibility. Live rank was checked only for the head term (page A). Empeon's nine PBJ/HPPD top-ten terms: how to calculate hppd (1), hppd nursing (1), what is hppd in healthcare (1), calculating hppd (2), hours per patient day (2), what is pbj in healthcare (2), what is pbj reporting (3), payroll based journal (6), pbj reporting for nursing homes (6).

Four things sales can hold me to, and the definition I would sign first.

Nothing on this page needs media spend. Each item is a field, a page, a clock, or a proof asset a rep can use the week it ships.

1. THE MARKETING-SOURCED DEFINITION, DRAFTED FOR SIGNATURE IN WEEK ONE

TERM	DEFINITION	HUBSPOT FIELD	OWNER
First touch	First recorded session source on the contact	Original source, drill-down 1 and 2	Marketing
Lead creation source	Channel that created the contact record	Lead source, required on create	Marketing
Assist	Named marketing touch inside 30 days before deal creation	Marketing assist, multi-select, dated	Marketing
Opportunity source	Who created the deal and from what	Deal source, required, no blank allowed	Sales
Revenue source	Opportunity source of a closed-won deal, locked at close	Deal source at close, read-only	Sales ops

Rule: a deal is **marketing-sourced** only when lead creation source and opportunity source agree; everything else is assisted or partner-sourced and reported that way. At Align, \$1.91M of open pipeline carried no source at all, more than the entire website column. That is a field design problem; this table is the fix.

2. A SPEED-TO-LEAD SLA WITH A CLOCK AND AN OWNER

- Qualified form (named buyer, in-scope vertical) → owner auto-assigned inside 5 minutes.
- First human touch inside 1 business hour, logged in HubSpot as a call, email, or meeting.
- Unworked after 4 business hours → escalates to the VP of Sales.
- Two numbers on the sales dashboard every Monday: hours to first touch; qualified-form-to-meeting rate.

Why it is first: at Align, 7 of 22 qualified buyer leads were hot and never followed up, including a Chief People Officer who arrived from ChatGPT with an immediate need. Cheapest revenue on the board.

3. FOUR PAGES THAT ARE ALSO FOUR REP LANDING PAGES

PAGE (TITLE TO SHIP)	US / MO	REP USE
Healthcare payroll software Empeon	110	Head-term door
Home care payroll software Empeon	30	Home care outbound
PBJ reporting software Empeon	10	SNF compliance hook
Skilled nursing payroll software Empeon	<10	The Netchex list query

Keyword Planner US volumes, 14 Sep 2026. Low volume on a bottom-funnel term is a feature: these are typed by people with budget. Each page carries one next step, not five.

4. TWO PROOF ASSETS REPS ARE MISSING

THIS WEEK

The iQIES hook. QIES retires tomorrow, 15 September 2026; FQ4 PBJ filings have been iQIES-only since 17 August. A one-page "what changes in iQIES and how Empeon files it" piece is an outbound reason to call that expires in weeks. It goes to AEs before it goes on the blog.

The reporting answer. Capterra rates Empeon 4.8 of 5 across 46 reviews; the one recurring complaint is report customisation and implementation time, while Netchex sells "98% support satisfaction." A short, honest reporting-and-implementation proof page, with a named operator quote, closes the objection reps hear most on review sites.

THE THREE NUMBERS I WOULD SHARE WITH SALES

NUMBER	WHY SALES CARES
Marketing-sourced pipeline, \$ and count	One definition, one report, no argument
Hours to first touch on qualified forms	The SLA, kept or missed, by owner
Qualified-form-to-meeting rate	Whether inbound is worth a rep's hour

What I am not claiming. No causation for the \$2.19M of supported pipeline. No revenue forecast for Empeon. No live rank beyond the one result on page A. Company names appear only where a deal record already carries them.

Where each attributed lead entered, and what Search Console shows today.

Pulled read-only on 14 September 2026 from Align HCM's Search Console property and GA4 property through the Google APIs. Dates matter here: the Search Console property's history begins 27 July 2026, after the 15 July snapshot, and GA4 collected almost nothing from February to June. The February–July journeys therefore rest on HubSpot's own source capture, which is what the audit cites.

THE FOUR JOURNEYS, WITH THE PAGES THEY TOUCHED

DATE	DEAL / LEAD	SOURCE EVIDENCE	ENTRY PAGE	CONVERTING PAGE	OUTCOME
18 Feb 2026	Weissman · SmartCare 2026 Optimization	HubSpot: ORGANIC_SEARCH / GOOGLE, keywords SSL-masked	/blog	/contact	Closed Won · \$54,000
27 Mar 2026	RPM xConstruction · SmartCare Services	HubSpot: ORGANIC_SEARCH / GOOGLE	/partners/ukg	/contact	Proposal/Quote · \$15,000
21 Apr 2026	Eat'n Park · UTA to Pro WFM	HubSpot: DIRECT_TRAFFIC, 8 pageviews	/	/contact	Qualification · \$400,000
1 Jul 2026	AI-referred qualified lead (no deal)	HubSpot: AI_REFERRALS / chatgpt.com	/dayforce-implementation?utm_source=chatgpt.com	/services/support	No follow-up logged

HubSpot contact analytics: first URL, conversion page, and source fields, from the deal evidence ledger of 15 July 2026. Google masks the query behind SSL, so the entry keyword for the Weissman visit is not recoverable from any tool. The blog index, not a single post, was the recorded entry URL.

SEARCH CONSOLE · QUERIES WHERE ALIGNHCM.COM RANKS IN THE TOP TEN, 27 JUL–11 SEP 2026 (NON-BRAND)

QUERY	AVG POS.	IMPR.	RANKING PAGE
dayforce consulting partners known for responsive support and quick issue resolution...	3.9	121	/dayforce-implementation
"dayforce" stabilization	3.8	26	/dayforce-implementation
"dayforce" optimization	4.4	36	/blog/dayforce-optimization-after-go-live
5 ways of hcm implementation	4.4	91	/blog/5-critical-mistakes-to-avoid-during-hcm-implementation
paychex vs paylocity	4.5	200	/blog/paylocity-vs-paychex-best-platform
dayforce consulting firms specializing in api integrations with existing time tracking...	4.9	189	/dayforce-implementation
ukg	5.1	40	/partners/ukg
accenture dayforce implementation partner	5.7	55	/dayforce-implementation
"dayforce" post implementation	5.7	30	/blog/how-leading-organizations-unlock-dayforce-s-full-potential...
"dayforce" configuration	6.1	36	/blog/the-configuration-decisions-that-determine-whether-dayforce...
best dayforce consulting services for large enterprises...	6.8	20	/dayforce-implementation
"dayforce" implementation	7.8	21	/dayforce-implementation

Impression-weighted average position. The two long queries are the shape of AI-assistant searches; both land on the Dayforce implementation page, the same page the ChatGPT-referred lead arrived on. Brand queries ("align hcm", 190 clicks at position 1.5) excluded.

Forty-seven days of organic search, and the measurement gap the audit describes.

552

ORGANIC CLICKS, 27 JUL–11 SEP

Search Console, web search, all countries.

92,972

IMPRESSIONS, SAME WINDOW

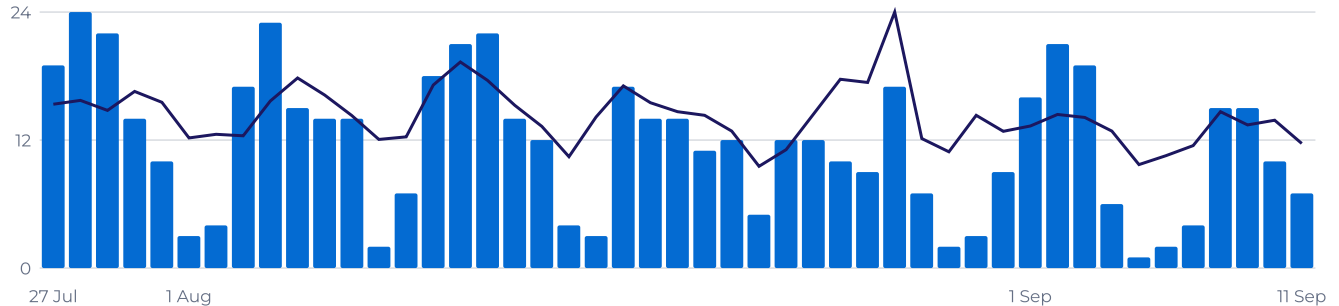
Average position 16.3; most impressions are page two.

Feb–Jun

GA4 BLIND SPOT

1 session recorded in five months. Tracking resumed late July.

DAILY CLICKS (BARS) AND IMPRESSIONS (LINE), 27 JUL–11 SEP 2026



PAGES BY IMPRESSIONS, SAME WINDOW

PAGE	IMPR.	POS.	CLICKS
/blog/the-strategic-buyers-guide-to-ukg	9,126	9.3	12
/partners/ukg	7,201	21.6	18
/ (homepage)	6,277	27.6	212
/blog/best-practices-for-implementing-workday-a-strategic-guide-to-success	5,559	25.1	5
/blog/hris-data-migration-checklist-15-steps	3,716	12.2	13
/blog/hris-hcm-implementation-checklist	3,272	19.6	15
/blog/data-conversion-checklist-what-to-prepare-before-migration	3,256	27.9	12
/blog/the-strategic-buyers-guide-to-paylocity	2,948	11.0	2
/dayforce-implementation	2,929	10.0	7
/blog/paylocity-training-implementation-methods	2,732	12.4	6

Seven of the top ten are blog posts or buyer's guides. The UKG buyer's guide alone drew 9,126 impressions at position 9.3; that is the "content is already there" pattern the audit describes at Empeon.

GA4 SESSIONS BY MONTH AND CHANNEL, 2026

MONTH	ORGANIC	DIRECT	REFERRAL	AI ASSISTANT
Jan	59	59	22	0
Feb	0	0	1	0
Mar	0	0	0	0
Apr	0	0	0	0
May	0	0	0	0
Jun	0	1	0	0
Jul	12	16	4	0
Aug	196	225	34	5
Sep 1–11	67	47	4	1

GA4 property "Align HCM - GA4". The February–June gap is the tracking failure the July findings named ("the connected GA4 does not contain Align HCM"). It was repaired in late July. ChatGPT referral landing pages since 26 Jan: homepage, /careers, the AWP-to-UKG case study, and /partners/ukg, one session each.

What this appendix proves and does not. It proves Align's organic footprint today and the pages that carry it. It does not show February rankings, because no tool captured them; the audit never claimed a February rank, only a Google Organic entry recorded by HubSpot.